1910–1994

DOROTHY HODGKIN

A leader in crystallography, British chemist Dorothy Hodgkin revealed the structure of complex molecules, including insulin.

MILESTONES

PRESTIGIOUS COMPANY
Elected as Fellow of the Royal Society in 1947, in recognition of her work on penicillin.

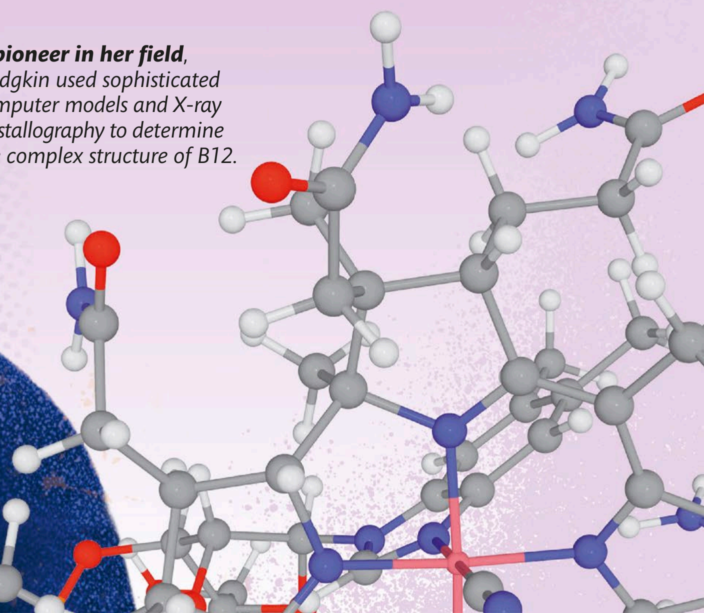
SCIENTIFIC RECOGNITION
In 1964, wins Nobel Prize in Chemistry. A year later, given the Order of Merit, one of the UK's highest honors.

GLOBAL CAUSE
Acts as president of the Pugwash Conferences, which pursue world peace, from 1976 to 1988.

As a child, Dorothy Hodgkin developed a passion for crystals and would analyze garden stones with a mineral-testing kit. She went on to study physics and chemistry at Oxford University, where she learned about using X-ray crystallography to model the structure of a crystal. She obtained a PhD and became an expert in this new field. In 1942, Hodgkin was asked to analyze the crystals of penicillin salts, and after 3 years of research, she succeeded. At the time, penicillin was the largest molecule to have been described using this method.

Hodgkin went on to identify the structure of vitamin B12 and, in 1969, the hormone insulin—a structure she had begun studying 35 years earlier. She considered this her greatest discovery.

A lifelong champion of social equality, Hodgkin devoted her later years to the advocacy of disarmament and peace.



***A pioneer in her field**, Hodgkin used sophisticated computer models and X-ray crystallography to determine the complex structure of B12.*